

Zeotap:
Helping brands
better
understand
their
customers to
improve
marketing
efforts

Tell us your challenge. We're here to help.

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[About Zeotap](#)



About Zeotap

Zeotap builds and
customer intelligence
products for client
by improving data
processing speed
BigQuery.

Zeotap is a customer intelligence platform (CIP) that helps brands understand their customers and predict behaviors so that they can improve customer engagement. From customer data unification to identity resolution, Zeotap works with global brands, agencies, and publishers across Europe and Asia Pacific. The company was recognized by Gartner as a "Cool Vendor" in 2020 and by AdExchanger as the "Best Data-Enabling Technology" in 2019.

Industries: Technology

Google Cloud results

- Reduces operation load by 80% with BigQuery to increase product delivery
- Helps Zeotap's customers achieve more accurate targeting by enhancing its API offering
- Pub/Sub acts as a queuing engine to eliminate bottlenecks in the data pipeline

Increase product speed with low operation

Location: India

Data Fusion

rackspace
technology.

About Rackspace Technology

Rackspace Technology (Rackspace) is a multicloud solution expert with a mission to deliver innovative cloud capabilities to help customers solve business challenges. A premier managed services partner for Google Cloud, Rackspace has been named as a leader in the Gartner 2020 Magic Quadrant for Public Cloud Infrastructure Professionals and Managed Services.

TECHNOLOGY

Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>)

Rackspace Technology (Rackspace) is a BigQuery (<https://cloud.google.com/bigquery/>)

Cloud Data Fusion
(<https://cloud.google.com/data-fusion/>)

Cloud Dataproc
(<https://cloud.google.com/dataproc/>)

as a leader in the Gartner 2020 Magic Dataflow (<https://cloud.google.com/dataflow/>)

Cloud Pub/Sub (<https://cloud.google.com/pubsub/>)

Customers today expect brands to know what they want. In fact, Forbes cited that 71% of customers

feel frustrated

(<https://www.forbes.com/sites/blakemorgan/2020/02/18/50-stats-showing-the-power-of-personalization/?sh=66fefa9c2a94>)

when the shopping experience is impersonal. From interests to purchase habits, companies need to target customers effectively in order to stand out from the plethora of competitors in the online marketplace.

"Our mission is
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*—Projjol Banerjea, co-
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Leveraging first-, second-, and third-party data, Zeotap's Customer Intelligence Platform (CIP)—a CDP with additional identity resolution and third-party data enrichment capabilities—allows brands to engage with their known and unknown users with tailored marketing messages and next best offers or actions. It also offers out-of-box algorithms for standard marketing use cases such as promoting a specific product that will resonate with audiences and custom algorithms for very niche and specific use cases.

"Our mission is to help brands engage customers with the most appropriate marketing messages at the right place and at the right time while respecting consumer privacy and ensuring regulatory compliance. The experience of Google Cloud in working with large-scale datasets makes the platform an excellent fit for us," says Projjol

Banerjea, co-founder and Chief Product Officer at Zeotap.

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—Sathish K S, VP
Engineering, Zeotap

**Improving data processing to
deliver products faster**

The cloud-native company migrated from its previous provider to Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>) in October 2019 because it was attracted to the benefits of BigQuery ([/bigquery](#)) as a serverless cloud data warehouse. This was a feature that wasn't available with its previous provider. Sathish K S, Engineering Vice-President at Zeotap says, "With BigQuery, we are able to operate more efficiently, removing 80% of the operation load that we would otherwise have to manage on a different cloud provider. As a result, we get to build and deliver products faster." Since coming onboard BigQuery, Zeotap has been able to increase the speed of its product delivery by 40%.

BigQuery also offers a much higher query limit, which is helpful because Zeotap can converge all of its previous operation load across different platforms into one data warehouse without worrying about it being overloaded.

One of the key services Zeotap offers is customer relationship management (CRM) platform integration. Using Dataflow ([/dataflow](#)), Zeotap can easily stream first-party data into BigQuery at scale. The data integration capabilities of Cloud Data Fusion ([/data-fusion](#)) also complements Dataflow to help Zeotap enhance its API offerings. To illustrate, an ecommerce company may use Zeotap's internal API to understand their customer's cart and check-out habits and add Zeotap's extra layer of data intelligence to it, so they can improve their marketing efforts. Cloud Data Fusion enables a seamless flow of real-time data so that the company can deliver the relevant ads or suggest products just before they

make a purchase, which increases the likelihood of them buying more.

Zeotap uses Datapro (/dataproc) and Pub/Sub (/pubsub) to manage the large flow of data that goes in and out of its database. Because many of its customers are pushing data in real time, Pub/Sub acts as a queuing engine that feeds them into Dataflow. Likewise, the data from Dataflow is also being channeled back smoothly to the customer endpoints using Pub/Sub.

Being able to automate all of its processes benefitted the DevOps team, as they now have time to focus on developing and improving Zeotap's product offerings instead of spending time and energy on operations.



Zeotap founders

Managing a full migration seamlessly

Today, all of Zeotap's data is hosted on Google Cloud. The company began its lift and shift migration in October 2019 and was complete by April 2020. "We have close to 405 data pipelines, and even after the migration, we had to verify the right datasets. We had terabytes of data to move, and despite this, our operations were not affected," says Aditya Chandra, Vice-President of Infrastructure and Security at Zeotap.

Apart from the BigQuery capabilities, there were other major things Zeotap looked out for in its decision to move to a new cloud provider. The functional parity of Google Cloud was important so that it did not have to rebuild many of its existing structures. Zeotap also didn't want any drop in performance during and after the move to a new cloud provider. Finally, as a multi-region company, it used to have to spot instance problems and run them on demand, which had cost implications. With the move, it no longer had to face such issues.

"Whatever Spark code that was already running on our existing system had to be lifted and shifted into Dataproc without any library changes because 60% of our codebase is out of there. We're glad that this was possible," says Ameya Agnihotri, Chief Technology Officer.

Managing business continuity with a trusted partner

Zeotap now works with [Rackspace Technology](https://www.rackspace.com/) (<https://www.rackspace.com/>) (Rackspace) as it continues to optimize its infrastructure operations.

As a marketing and technology company, Zeotap needs niche expertise to manage big data processing issues. Ameya Agnihotri shares, "Given its global expertise in dealing with on-premises as well as cloud solutions, Rackspace can really add value because they are better equipped to troubleshoot and handle complex data operations." Zeotap has plans to explore more of Google Cloud's artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) capabilities, so having a partner in this journey will be valuable to the team.

With so much data on hand, security is paramount to Zeotap. It does a lot of internal security assessments daily. This is one of the areas where the team works with Rackspace to ensure that it adopts best practices and stays on top of the latest updates. With its ability to handle big data operations, Rackspace also acts as an extension of the Zeotap team that supports the infrastructure side of the business.

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—Ameya Agnihotri , Chief
Technology Officer,
Zeotap

Future plans and collaboration with Google Cloud

Zeotap is currently exploring Cloud Bigtable (/bigtable) and API Gateway (/api-gateway) as it continues to grow the business and explore new types of services to offer to its customers. Although it has a software-as-a-service (SaaS) offering for customers to self-serve, some may prefer to do a server-to-server integration so that they do not have to worry about the back end at all. For this reason,

Zeotap is exploring the possibility of integrating these customers' APIs in the back end of its API, using Google Cloud's API Gateway features that are available out of the box. The company is also looking forward to the new features being released on BigQuery, as well as exploring more of the [alerting and monitoring](/monitoring/alerts) capabilities of Google Cloud.

"The level of engagement from Google Cloud has been excellent, particularly the ability to bring in expertise from different parts of the organization," says Ameya. He shares that the team has had many fortnightly calls when there were issues to address, and the Google Cloud team would help to fix the problems. "The personal touch meant we could reach product owners and managers of specific products. This kind of support is what we really value and appreciate."

With big plans ahead for Zeotap that include becoming a Google Cloud Technology Partner in the near future, Swapnasarit Sahu, Chief Data and Analytics Officer, is confident that the company has chosen the right cloud solution. "We see Google as one of the frontrunners in the space of AI and ML solutions, which can really help data scientists in developing new and more innovative products and solutions, and we look forward to building great products with them," he says.



Zeotap team
